

BOB INGRAM



CURTICE

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ONE OBSERVATION of the nearly week old Super Bowl is that Chuck Foreman of the Minnesota Vikings ran like Percy Foreman, the noted criminal lawyer . . . The Super Bowl has been a Super Bore more often than not, maybe because it's a one-game affair . . . Give me the World Series between the Cincinnati Reds and Boston Red Sox, the NBA title series between the Boston Celtics and Phoenix Suns or the NCAA basketball championship finals involving the four surviving teams . . . The Miners had a perfect 11 for 11 at the free throw line against Arizona State Thursday night . . . It's not a record . . . The UTEP team on Feb. 1, 1969 was 15 of 15 against Oklahoma City Christian College . . . Another big cash-in job occurred for the Miners against New Mexico State on Jan. 21, 1971 . . . They hit 20 of 21 free throws . . . When the Lobos win in their famed "Pit," would you say they epitomized their opponents? . . . Some of these basketball players who commit turnovers by throwing the ball away got their early training as news carrier boys pitching papers under the shrubbery or on the roof . . . One pretty good comment is that Southwest Conference basketball is no longer a basket case . . . According to the Chinese, this is the year of the snake . . . How did the inscrutable Chinese know that Ken (the Snake) Stabler would lead the Oakland Raiders to a Super Bowl victory . . . Trick question: Is there any coach, football or basketball, in the WAC who has beaten every team in the conference . . . It's doubtful because the coach performing that feat would have had to coach at two WAC schools . . . Item for Hal Eurich, KDBC weather man, about that small town: It's so small that they start the ambulance by saying "giddup."

Long grind

NED WULK, the Arizona State basketball coach, doesn't think competition in the PAC-10 will be any tougher than it has been in the WAC . . . But it will be a longer grind . . . The loop competition will be 18 games instead of 14 . . . Albuquerque has made some small talk about acquiring the Fiesta Bowl from Phoenix . . . A better move, due to weather advantages, would be San Diego, if the Fiesta leaves Phoenix . . . NCAA indicates that it will not sanction any more bowls this year . . . Birmingham is interested in being a bowl site . . . Good possibilities in the future are Seattle in its King Dome and Detroit for its Pontiac Dome . . . Andy Cohen is a candidate for the Texas High School Basketball Hall of Fame at Athens . . . Kiko

Martinez, formerly of El Paso, and Mario Palafox of El Paso are members . . . I also thought Mike Izquierdo of this city was a member but don't see his name in the list of enshrinementees . . . Yes, Andy Cohen played basketball . . . He was a member of the El Paso High team that won the first state high school crown . . . Back in 1920 or '21 . . . What they're doing now: Tony Lovitt, who did public relations work and radio-TV broadcasting the last two years for El Paso/Juarez Sol volleyballers, will work in the same capacity with the newly-organized Denver Comets of the International Volleyball Assn. . . Don Rickles was the guest at a party for the writers before the Super Bowl game . . . Spotting one of the new breed of sport writers dressed like a ditch digger or farmer, Rickles asked: "Where did you park your dump truck?" . . . "I guess," added Rickles, "I should have showed up wearing only a jock strap."

Memorial opener

AFTER TODAY'S game with Arizona, the U.T. El Paso Miners move into their new super facility, the Extra Events Center . . . Who remembers the first college game played by the Miners in Memorial? . . . According to the records it was against St. Michael's Horsemen of Santa Fe, on Dec. 12, 1961 . . . The Miners won 97-71 . . . Prior to that season, the Miners played in Holliday Hall, which is now being used as campus offices, and the Coliseum . . . Memorial Gym will continue to be used . . . for intramural contests, etc. . . . Despite the fact that he's retired as a coach, Jack Curtice is still active in college football . . . The former U.T. El Paso coach is an advisor to the rules committee . . . He's sort of a liaison man . . . According to him, there won't be many rule changes for the 1977 season . . . The rules committee may be considering a tie-breaker plan in college football and a rule that would start games by a kickoff from the 35-yard line instead of the 40 . . . However, neither is expected to be put in the rules . . . The New York Times and The Sporting News rated Texas A&M No. 3 in football for last season, which covered the bowl play, behind Pittsburgh and Southern California . . . The Texas Aggies which beat Florida in the Sun Bowl on Jan. 2, thus, has the highest rating of any team to play in the El Paso game . . . It seems somewhat significant that Robert H. Forrest of Carlsbad, a former UTEP football star, has been reappointed to a five-year term on New Mexico State Game Commission. If game violators can't see the forest for the trees, they may see a Forrest.